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The Yale Political Monthly

An Undergraduate Publication

Does Israel Have the Right to Hold the West Bank?

YPM Debate: Part I–Israel Has the Right to Defend Itself

Enemies on the Right

The Radical Danger to the Republican Party

The Persistence of Amnesia: Dachau, 1990

A Context for German Reunification

India's Dilemma

Hussein's Hold on the Third World

VOLUME 12, NUMBER 2 ❦ NOVEMBER 1990

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VOLUME 12, NUMBER 2
NOVEMBER, 1990

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Debate: Does Israel Have the Right to Hold the West Bank?

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Israel Has the Right to Defend Itself

Mark Barnett

The State of Israel is justified in occupying the territory commonly referred to as the West Bank. Israel's right to occupy that territory is based on its right to protect itself from the hostility of its Arab neighbors. Thus, in order to prove that Israel has a right to occupy the West Bank, it first must be established that the State of Israel has a right to exist, for any state with a right to exist has a right to defend itself. In order to understand Israel's right and need to exist, two things must be considered. One, the Jewish people have a historical tie to the land and thus a right to it; it is their homeland. Two, the Jews' dispersal throughout the world and the history of anti-semitism in Europe ending in the Holocaust absolutely necessitated the creation of Israel. The basis for the existence of the State of Israel extends all the way back to approximately 1100 BCE when the Jews made their exodus from Egypt into the land that is now Israel. Enslaved for centuries, the Jewish people now had a homeland. Through their religious beliefs they developed common values; they spoke a common language; they shared a common culture and now a common homeland. In every sense, the Jewish people had become a nation.

They prospered as a nation in this land until 586 BCE when the armies of Nebuchadnezzar invaded. The Jewish people were driven into exile in Babylonia. Although they were exiled, Israel never ceased being the Jewish nation's homeland. Contrary to the fate of many exiled peoples, the Jewish nation did not disappear into Babylonian civilization. The Jews maintained their beliefs and identity for centuries away from home. In exile, they remained a nation and swore never to forget their homeland. The Jews vowed to regain *Eretz Israel,* the land of Israel.

Gradually, the Jews began to return to the land they called Judea. By 166 BCE, the Jews had returned in great enough numbers to begin a rebellion against Greek rule. By 141, the Jewish rebels had won back full control of Judea.

The Jewish people again were more or less a unified nation; however, in 70 CE, the Romans invaded the land, renaming it "Palestine". The Jews refused to live under Roman rule. There were irreconcilable ideological differences between the monotheistic Jews and the polytheistic Romans. The Romans treated the Jews and their holy places with great disrespect because the Jews refused to worship the Roman Emperor and the Roman gods. The Jews, therefore, revolted against what they considered oppressive Roman rule. They were overpowered by the great armies of the Roman Empire, so that, although many fought to the death, the majority of the Jews were exiled again. This time they dispersed all over the known world, and they would have to wait many more generations before they could return to *Eretz Israel.*[1]

"The persistence of the Jewish people is a mystery unparalleled in the story of civilization."[2] Jews traveled to the four corners of the Earth and took root in every major civilization on the planet. From the Greek word for "scattering", the Jews living outside the land of Israel became known as the *diaspora*. The mystery is how the Jewish people maintained their identity throughout the two thousand years of the diaspora. As a defenseless minority, they faced persecution in some form in every place they

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Mark Barnett is a Freshman in Morse.
The debate will continue in the next issue.

chose to live. Yet the Jews refused to take the easy way out–assimilation. It would have been so simple–the Jews could have given up their traditions and beliefs, begun to intermarry, and blended into society. Their situation was different from that of other oppressed minorities throughout the world. Since the Jews were of the same skin color as their countrymen, for the most part, in a few generations, the Jews could have completely assimilated. By choosing Judaism over assimilation, the Jews were choosing death in many instances. Many did convert; but the existence of the Jewish people today is testament to the strength of their collective will to maintain their Judaism.

As a result of their devotion to Judaism and their refusal to assimilate, the Jews have experienced severe persecution. Two major events, the birth of Christianity and the rise of nationalism, are responsible for the anti-semitism which the Jews have suffered. It was with the birth of Christianity that anti-semitism became widely practiced. The Christians would not tolerate the Jews because they did not follow Christianity. While the Jews were still in Judea Jesus of Nazareth, who was born a Jew, began preaching his moral principles. "For almost 2,000 years, the Christian perception has often been that the Jews were responsible for Jesus' death."[3] In reality, the Roman Empire saw the danger that the ideas of Jesus posed to its survival and for this reason they put Jesus to death. The Jews' failure to accept Jesus as their savior accounted for the resentment on the part of those who did accept him. Many Jews followed Jesus and eventually became Christians. Most Jews, however, while realizing the greatness of his ideas, refused to accept Jesus as divine, triggering hatred among the Christians. Thus, anti-semitism spread with the rise of Christianity.

Most of the exiled Jews went to predominantly Christian Europe. In these Christian societies, a negative Jewish stereotype was perpetuated through "theological debates, preachers' sermons, popular traditions, and through works of literature, painting and sculpture. So profoundly did this negative stereotype penetrate the mentality and culture of the European peoples in particular, that its main features survived the waning of the Church's influence among enlightened circles and the rise of critical-rationalist currents and scientific thinking."[4] The policy of the Catholic Church promoted the hatred of the Jews in order to encourage their conversion to Christianity. The Church was motivated by the idea of augmenting its power by having all people be of the Catholic faith.

As states began to form in Western Europe, the necessity for national unity arose. National unity required a common state religion. Thus, the rise of nationalism, coupled with Christianity, continued anti-semitism in Europe. There were now two powers with motives to convert the Jews. The Church still wanted to consolidate its own power and the leaders of State needed to consolidate their power. The attempt to convert turned into an ultimatum: convert or leave. The Jews were expelled first from England in the twelfth century, then from France in the thirteenth century, and finally from Spain in 1492. In Spain, especially, the Jews had become an integral part of society. At first the Jews had found harsh opposition to their presence in Spain. They remained there for centuries, however, and eventually found a secure place in Spanish society. In fact, during the generations preceding 1492 the Jews had prospered tremendously. They had attained high levels in the economic and even political structure of Spain. When the Catholics in Spain decided to unify their nation by converting everyone to Catholicism, the Jews' prosperity in Spain came to an abrupt end. Many chose to convert to Catholicism. Of those who converted, however, many maintained their Jewish identity and the Jewish traditions in secret; when discovered they were killed. Much of the Jewish population of Spain left rather than give up Judaism. They migrated to Eastern Europe where another great diaspora community was formed.

After several centuries of relative tolerance in Eastern Europe, anti-semitism coupled with nationalism again began to rise during the latter half of the nineteenth century. The Russians "attacked Jews for their separatism but usually imposed laws forbidding their right to participate freely in Russian society unless they converted."[5] In 1790 the Jews were forced to live in a vast ghetto called "the Pale of Settlement". It was in the Pale of Settlement that the Modern Zionist movement began to form. This movement called for the recreation of a homeland for the Jewish nation in what was then Palestine. The Jews decided that they would no longer accept their position as a defenseless minority. They realized that God was not going to save them — they had to save themselves.

As a result of their refusal to assimilate, the Jews have been subject to persecution

By choosing Judaism over assimilation the Jews were choosing death in many instances

In 1881, Tsar Alexander II was assassinated. Alexander had been very tolerant of the Jews and had allowed them to live peacefully. Under Alexander, the Jews had obtained many new freedoms. In contrast, Alexander's successor, Alexander III, allowed, if not encouraged, the continuance of pogroms — raids on Jewish villages which usually included rape, pillage and murder. Thousands of Jews were killed. With the re-emergence of the pogroms, the Jews of Russia realized that they had to get out of the country. Between 1900 and 1914, 1.5 million Jews left Russia. Most went to America; some, however, looked towards Palestine.

After the outbreak of the pogroms in Russia and throughout the beginning of the twentieth century, many Jews tried to get out of Europe. They realized that any hope of security in Europe was false.

Hitler could not have decimated the Jews of Europe so successfully without help

Theodor Herzl continued what the Jews of Russia began. Living in France, he was aware of a disturbing amount of anti-semitism. His eyes were opened to anti-semitism by the Dreyfus affair in which a French Army officer was framed and falsely accused of committing treason because he was Jewish. Herzl concluded that the Jews would never be secure in Europe and that a Jewish state was necessary to provide a safe haven for Jews. Herzl proceeded to found the World Zionist Organization which attempted, above all, to obtain for all of the Jews of the world a safe passage to a Jewish State. Herzl believed that no Jew was safe living as a minority in the diaspora. His goal was to recreate a home for the Jewish nation where all Jews could find shelter from anti-semitism.

Many Jews attempted to get out of Europe, and many did. On the eve of World War II, millions of Jews remained in Europe. The Jews, in exile from their homeland, had been forced to live as a minority for almost 1900 years. They had tried to live peacefully in Europe. In the West, they were slowly gaining legal rights and beginning to gain social equality. In the East, especially in Poland, they had worked to become accepted by the society and had made some progress. Throughout all of their history in Europe they had experienced long periods of toleration where they had mistakenly come to believe that they were secure. In the ninetennth and twentieth centuries, however, it became unmistakably clear that the Jewish people would never be secure in Europe.

The democracies of the West turned their backs on the Jews

In 1941, Adolf Hitler began his attempt at the organized, systematic destruction of the Jewish people. He had determined that the Jewish race that must be exterminated: the previous European policy of expelling the Jews was not decisive enough for him. Although he also attacked Gypsies, homosexuals, and other smaller minorities, the Jews were clearly his main targets. By the end of the war, Hitler and the Nazis had murdered six million Jews, two-thirds of all the Jews in Europe.[6]

Hitler could not have decimated the Jews of Europe so successfully without the help of the non-Jews living in the countries he occupied. In Eastern Europe, Hitler and his Nazi killing machine found no opposition among the ranks of anti-semites living in those countries. The people of Poland stood by as the Jews, ten percent of the population, were penned into ghettos and then transported off to Auschwitz, Treblinka, Majdanek — camps of death. In the Ukraine, Lithuania, and other Eastern European countries, many people actually helped the Nazis murder the Jews. Hitler's task of extermination was made easy by the complacency and, occasionally, assistance of the European peoples. There were undoubtably acts of heroism in which people risked their lives to save their countrymen, but these were few and far between.

Denmark's defiance shows that the atrocities could have been prevented had the "innocent bystanders" cared. Not a single Jew in Denmark was killed. The people of Denmark decided that they would not let their countrymen die at the swords of the Nazis. When the Nazi SS issued the order that each Jew must wear a yellow star signifying his religion, the King of Denmark was the first to wear the star and he ordered everyone in the country to wear such a star. The Nazis repealed the order the next day. Then, the Danes transported nearly all of their Jews in boats to neutral Sweden. All of the Jews of Denmark survived the Holocaust.

Fortunately for Adolf Hitler, the Danish people were the exception. The democracies of the West turned their backs on Europe's Jews on the eve of the war and during it as well. The two places in the world that had previously accepted Jews, the United States and British-controlled Palestine, for all intents and purposes denied the Jews entry.[7] Saving Jewish lives didn't serve their interests. By 1942, the US knew what was going on inside the Nazi death camps. It would have been easy to bomb the

railroads, thus stopping the transportation of the Jews to the camps, yet the Allies did nothing to stop the genocide. The Jews had no one to help them. The day that the United States imposed strict quotas on the immigration of European Jews, thus sealing their fate, the Jewish community realized that a Jewish state was the only guarantee of their survival.

At the end of World War II, the survivors of the Holocaust did everything they could to get to Palestine. The need for the Jews to regain their homeland was clear: they had to find an escape from the hatred of Europe. Their right to their homeland, Palestine, was also clear. For nearly two thousand years the exiled Jews had prayed that some day they would return to *Eretz Israel*. The Jewish presence in Israel had been constant since the Romans had exiled them at sword-point. The Jews' love for the land of Israel and their identification of Israel as their homeland had been constant throughout the years of exile. The Jewish nation has as much right to its homeland as the Portugese people have to theirs or the Egyptian people have to theirs. The Jewish people is indeed "a nation which has survived some four thousand years, with the same religion, the same language, the same country, the same identity and culture — the only such nation in the world, with the possible exception of the Chinese."[8] The Jewish people comprise a nation and as a nation they have an intimate bond with their homeland, the land they call Israel.

The Jews already in Palestine had set up a governing body. Jewish settlements had been set up throughout Palestine with land legally acquired. They cultivated and worked the land with the goal of setting up an economic infrastructure before addressing their political needs. The Jewish people had survived two thousand years of exile in hostile lands and had returned to reunite as a nation and to make sure that they would no longer be defenseless against the anti-semitic people of the world.

The Jewish people brought their plea for nationhood before the United Nations. The British had had control over Palestine but they were unable to persuade the Arabs and Jews to reach a compromise. They agreed, therefore, to turn over the problem to a special UN commission. The Peel Commission proposed "termination of the British Mandate and partition of the area into a Palestinian Arab state and a Jewish state. The Jewish state was already in existence in all but name. But the Arabs boycotted" the committee.[9] *The UN called for the establishment of a Palestinian state and the Arabs rejected it!* The Jews signed the resolution, the Arabs never did. On 15 May 1948, the Jews in Palestine declared the independence of the State of Israel. The Jewish nation possessed a homeland once again. Yet, the anti-semitism from which the Jews had tried to escape was now manifest again in the hostility shown by all the Arabs in the region, including those living within the boundaries of the State of Israel.

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As the Jews arrived in Palestine, beginning in 1881, they reached out in friendship to the Arabs living there. They cooperated with many willing Arab villages in Palestine and together the Arabs and Jews were able to do well. The Jews only wanted peace. They had no aspirations for power, only peace and tranquility. After experiencing Birkenau and Bergen-Belson, how could they want anything but simply to live? Many Arabs understood the aims of the Jews and were friendly in return. There were also many Arabs, however, who were not willing to live peacefully with the Jews. In fact, they were fanatically opposed to this. Thus, when Israel's independence was declared on 15 May 1948, the surrounding Arab peoples declared war on Israel. The five Arab armies which invaded Israel in 1948 violated the UN resolution and thus nullified the Palestinian state which the UN had established.

The UN called for the establishment of a Palestinian state and the Arabs rejected it

It is a myth to believe that the Arabs who are anti-Israel are not anti-Jewish as well. Jews traditionally have experienced anti-semitism in Arab lands. Just as the Christian religion was anti-Jewish, Islam is anti-Jewish. The Jews rejected the teachings of Muhammad just as they had rejected the teachings of Jesus. The Muslims, like the Christians, resented the Jews for not following them. Albert Memmi, a Tunisian-born writer and political theorist, wrote, "It is not Zionism that has caused anti-semitism, but the other way around, just as in Europe. Israel is a rejoinder to the oppression suffered by the Jews the world over."[10] Israel was created out of absolute necessity. The Jews were oppressed throughout the entire world, including the Arab world. With the creation of the State of Israel there was finally a place where Jews always could go to escape oppression. With the creation of the State of Israel there was finally a country that would always come to the defense of Jews throughout the world subject to anti-semitism.

The Jews arriving in Palestine came seeking only peace

Unfortunately, the Palestinian Arabs who were hostile to the creation of Israel refused to see that the Jews came in peace. During the War of Independence, which the Jews were forced to fight against their belligerent neighbors, many Palestinian Arabs fled the country. A small number of these Arabs fled due to fear. The great majority of Palestinian Arabs, however, "left their homes on the specific instructions of their leaders, who, incidentally, were the first to leave. They promised that they would return in the wake of victorious Arab armies and inherit the spoil and the loot of the Jewish population, which would be annihilated and thrown into the sea."[11] The Arab leaders, who were clearly launching a war of aggression against the Jewish nation, wanted the Arabs out of the way so that they could sweep in and destroy the Jews. The Jews didn't want the Arabs to leave. Unfortunately the Palestinian Arab people were deceived by their leaders. In March of 1976, Abu Maze, a member of the executive committee of the PLO wrote: "The Arab armies entered Palestine to protect the Palestinians...but, instead, they abandoned them, forced them to emigrate and to leave their homeland, imposed upon them a political and ideological blockade and threw them into prisons similar to the ghettos in which the Jews used to live in Eastern Europe."[12] The Palestinian refugee problem, therefore, was created by the actions of the Arab leaders, *not* by the Jews. The Palestinian refugee problem involves the displacement of Palestinian Arabs and their desire to gain retribution.

The problem of Palestinian refugees is primarily the fault of the Arabs themselves

The Palestinian question, as it is commonly called, is not the cause of the conflict between Israelis and Arabs; it is the result of the conflict. The failure of the Arabs and their leaders to recognize the right and the need of the Jewish people to have their homeland in Palestine caused this conflict. The Arabs' failure to recognize Israel directly caused the 1948 war; that war led to the Palestinian Arabs leaving their homes and forfeiting the state which the UN had created for them.

The Palestinian Arabs claim that the Jews took their unique homeland. This is not true. There is not a single place in the land of Israel with a name of Arabic origin attached to it. The names which the Jews used for the places two thousand years ago all remain. In the West Bank, the Arabic names used for places are translations from Hebrew. The Palestinians, by never attaching their names to the land, never made it their own. More importantly, Palestinian nationalism never existed until the Jews began returning in great numbers during the 1930s. Palestinian nationalism only developed as a response to Jewish nationalism. A Palestinian people desiring a homeland in Palestine did not exist until the Jews came to reclaim the land of Israel. The Jews did not take the Palestinians' homeland. The Palestinians were never a nation; they were simply occupants, deserving full rights as humans, but not warranting rights as a nation. The creation of the Jewish nation did not preclude the Palestinians' right to live peacefully as occupants of the land.

The Jewish people did not want the Palestinian Arabs to evacuate. The Jews wanted the Arabs to stay and become a part of the State of Israel. "In February 1962, Salim Joubran, an Arab citizen of Israel, told American audiences of his own experience: 'The Arab High Command asked us to leave the country for two weeks to make the battle easier for them. They told us: 'A cannon cannot differentiate between a Jew and an Arab. Leave the country for two weeks and you will come back victorious...' I heard the Haganah [Israeli Army] microphone asking the Arabs to remain and live peacefully with their Jewish brethren. The late Jewish Mayor of Haifa also asked us to go back to our homes. The Histadrut, our trade union, was distributing leaflets asking the Arabs to come back. I still have that leaflet.'"[13] The Arab leaders were sure they would annihilate the Jews, thus allowing the Arabs to move back into Palestine. The Arab leaders told the Palestinian Arabs to leave. The Jews, however, asked the Arabs to stay and become a part of the State of Israel. The Jews wanted peace for themselves and for the Arabs.

The State of Israel did not want war against the Arabs in 1948, nor again in 1967. By 1967, however, each of the Arab countries surrounding Israel had built up its military forces and was prepared to attack. "In mid-May of 1967, President Gamal Abdel Nasser announced that 'Egypt, with all her resources — human, economic and scientific — is prepared to plunge into a total war that will be the end of Israel.'"[14] Egypt announced its intention to destroy Israel, a country whose existence Egypt and her allies never acknowledged, and began taking actions in preparation for war. On 30 May 1967, Nasser declared, "The armies of Egypt, Jordan, Syria

and Lebanon are poised on the borders of Israel."[15] In response to this threat and others, Israel made pre-emptive strikes on its enemies. The actions that Israel took were in self-defense and necessary to assure its survival. President Nassar correctly observed after the war that "...one of the obvious qualities in our enemy's [Israel's] position was his early feeling that if he lost once he would lose everything."[16] Any war Israel lost would be its end. Israel had no choice but to act after Nassar's declarations. The actions Israel took were clearly in self-defense. During the war Israel took control of the Sinai, the Golan Heights, the West Bank and the Gaza Strip. These territories were obtained during a defensive war.

From 1948 to 1967 the West Bank had existed outside the control of Israel; during that time it was under Jordanian control. When Israel won the Six-Day War, in 1967, it occupied the West Bank. Since then, Israel's right to occupy the West Bank has been a constant topic of debate.

The West Bank is the land along the western bank of the Jordan River extending as far west as Jerusalem. Many Palestinian Arabs living there had fled from Israel during the War of Independence. The Jordanian Government treated the Palestinian Arabs as a subject people. The Palestinians were put into refugee camps and denied their basic freedoms and their human dignity. "During the nineteen years that the Jordanians occupied the West Bank...they oppressed the Arab population and brutally suppressed the riots which broke out every few months."[17] Yassir Arafat, head of the Palestinian Liberation Organization declared in 1971 that twenty thousand of the West Bank Arabs were wounded or killed by Jordan during that time span. In fact, in a 1971 interview, West Bank Arabs who were visiting Lebanon admitted that Arab nationalism had betrayed and humiliated them. They said, "we had to wait for the Israeli conquest in order to become aware of human relationships with citizens."[18] When Israel took control of the West Bank it was a relative liberation for the Palestinian Arabs because the Jordanian oppression had finally ended. It can be very misleading to describe Israeli occupation of the West Bank as any kind of liberation for the Palestinian Arabs. Despite the fact that conditions did improve for them once the Israelis took control, the Palestinians would never acknowledge such a fact considering that they would never even acknowledge the mere existence of the State of Israel.

In 1964, while Jordan was in control of the West Bank, Palestinians in other Arab countries formed the Palestinian Liberation Organization. The PLO claims to be the representative of the Palestinian Arab people. Its goal is the creation of a state for the Palestinian Arabs encompassing all of Palestine. Thus, its goal is the abolition of the State of Israel. The Palestinian National Covenant, actually the governing doctrine of the PLO, was written in 1964. Many of the thirty-three articles of the covenant discuss the use of violence in creating a Palestinian homeland and in destroying the State of Israel. In Article 19 of the covenant, the PLO declares that "the establishment of Israel is fundamentally null and void."[19] The representative of the Palestinian Arab people, the PLO, refuses to recognize Israel.

In 1967, in a defensive war, Israel occupied the West Bank — the home of the PLO. In November of 1967, the UN Security Council dealt with the Israeli occupation by adopting Resolution 242. In this resolution, the Palestinian Arabs were asked to acknowledge "the sovereignty, territorial integrity and political independence of every State in the area and their right to live in peace within secure and recognized boundaries". Israel was asked to withdraw from the territories *after* negotiations between Israel and the Palestinian Arabs.[20] Two absolutely essential events must occur, therefore, before Israel withdraws from the West Bank. One, the Palestinian Arabs must clearly demonstrate that they acknowledge Israel's right to exist. This clearly cannot happen through the PLO. Two, there must be negotiations between Israel and the Palestinian Arabs. These negotiations also cannot occur through the PLO. Until these events occur, *Israel's occupation of the West Bank is justified.*

The PLO does not truly recognize the right of the State of Israel to exist; it has declared this definitively and repeatedly. On 9 April 1981, Farouk Kaddoumi, head of the PLO's Political Department, declared, "I hope I am making myself clear to everyone everywhere... We have said it over and over again that we refuse to recognize Israel. This is an unchangeable, permanent policy."[21] Kaddoumi's statements are supported by numerous other statements made by high ranking members of the PLO. Even after the PLO's Geneva Declaration in December 1988, it cannot be said that the PLO recognizes Israel's

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Until the Arabs recognize Israel's right to exist, Israel is justified in occupying the West Bank

right to exist. In that declaration, Arafat announced his belief in Israel's right to exist and renounced terrorism. In reality, however, the PLO has done neither. As recently as 1 May 1990, Yassir Arafat made clear his failure to recognize Israel by declaring, "The Palestinian people's struggle will continue until the complete liberation of Palestinian land...The Palestinian's [*sic*] people's struggle ought to be assisted until the complete liberation of Palestine from the river to the sea...We will fight until the last bullet, until the last drop of blood, and until the last stone in our land."[22] Clearly, Arafat and the PLO never truly acknowledged the right of Israel to exist, nor did the PLO ever truly renounce the use of terrorism. "Since the adoption of the PLO covenant, 'armed struggle' has been the term used by the PLO to characterize terrorist attacks on innocent civilians...Arafat openly contradicted his December 1988 statement 'renouncing terrorism', when on 6 June 1989, at a press conference in Kuwait, he said, "The PLO will not stop the armed struggle'."[23] Thus, Arafat has undoubtably shown that he neither renounces terrorism nor has reversed his earlier refusal to recognize the existence of Israel. Finally, by embracing Saddam Hussein, a man who massacred his own people and who has pledged to destroy Israel, the PLO definitively demonstrates its failure to acknowledge truly Israel's right to exist. By not recognizing Israel, the PLO specifically goes against its obligation in Resolution 242.

The PLO has forbidden local Arab leaders to negotiate with Israel

Secondly, the withdrawal of Israel from the occupied territories cannot take place without negotiations. Hopefully, the dialogue between the leaders of Israel and the leaders of the PLO eventually would lead at least to mutual understanding. How can Israel be asked to sit down and negotiate with an organization founded to destroy Israel? As has been demonstrated, no matter what the PLO says to appease world opinion, it will never recognize the right of Israel to exist. Fundamentally, the PLO's ideology is based upon the quest for a Palestinian state encompassing all of Palestine, thus eliminating Israel. The PLO has asserted repeatedly that it will not compromise. Yassir Arafat declared long before the Geneva Conference: "I am not a man of settlements and concessions. I will struggle till the last inch of Palestine is returned."[24] This attitude explains Arafat's failure to stand behind his supposed compromise at the Geneva Conference. Arafat maintains his intention to eliminate Israel. Thus, Israel cannot recognize the PLO or it is recognizing its own destruction. In order for Israel to negotiate, it must be allowed to negotiate with a representative body of the Palestinian Arabs which recognizes the fundamental right of Israel to exist. This representative body must recognize the need for rational compromise. The Israeli government also must recognize this need.

Israel occupied the West Bank in a defensive war and maintains it to insure its survival

Although Israel does not recognize the legitimacy of the PLO, Israel does recognize the rights of the Palestinian Arab people to live. On numerous occasions, Israel has attempted to negotiate with local Palestinian Arab leaders. The PLO has forbidden any such negotiations. The PLO does not want the Palestinians to compromise — it would usurp their power. In fact, some left wing policy makers outside the influence and control of the government have been meeting secretly with the PLO for the last decade. These negotiations progressed slowly until the Israelis broke them off when the PLO embraced Saddam Hussein, a man who gassed ten to twenty thousand of his own people.

Israel cannot be expected to withdraw from the occupied territories until a Palestinian Arab leadership arises which clearly demonstrates its belief in Israel's right to exist. In the ensuing negotiations, Israel would have to be assured definitively that a stable, peaceful state will be established in the West Bank after Israeli withdrawal.

The threat of the Arab countries which surround Israel precipitated the Israeli occupation of the West Bank. By taking the West Bank, Israel assured its security against these hostile nations who would not accept its existence. Israel conquered the territory in self-defense. Israel has no intention of keeping the land permanently; Israel would *not* be justified in keeping the land permanently. Israel's justification for occupying the West Bank will last only as long as it is apparent that leaving the land would pose a threat to Israel's survival.

The situation in the Gaza Strip is similar in many ways to that in the West Bank. The population in Gaza is predominantly Palestinian Arab. The population of Gaza was persecuted by Egypt during the time from 1948 to 1967 just as the population of the West Bank was harassed by Jordan during the same time period. The PLO in reality represents both groups of people. Thus, by addressing Israel's justification for occupying the West Bank, one addresses the justification for the Israeli occupation of Gaza.

Israel's presence in both the West Bank

and the Gaza Strip is justified in order to prevent a hostile Arab presence in those strategic areas. With long, hard negotiations and the passage of time, a Palestinian state or states with truly peaceful, cooperative aims can be set up in the occupied territories. Until Israel can be assured of the peaceful intentions of the people in those areas, the Israeli occupation is justified. When the time comes, both sides must be prepared to compromise.

Israel has proven its willingness to compromise. Israel has compromised. In 1982, the peace process between Israel and Egypt was completed. In exchange for peace, Israel agreed to return to Egypt the Sinai desert, which Israel had taken in self-defense during the war of 1967. The Sinai desert is an oil-rich area *one-third* the size of the entire State of Israel which was very valuable to Israel. Israel took a risk by giving back the Sinai; the possibility existed that "Israel would be faced with new threats and perhaps even destruction. Israel gave up tangibles (land, oil, air bases, strategic depth) in exchange for intangibles (pledges)."[25] When the opportunity arose to make peace with its worst enemy, Israel took the opportunity and returned the Sinai desert to Egypt.

Israel's goal is to make peace with all of its neighbors. It has already shown its willingness to do so in making peace with Egypt. Israel's intentions in the West Bank and the Gaza Strip only involve ensuring peace and political stability in the region. Once the Palestinian Arabs begin supporting a leadership that recognizes the right of Israel to exist and the need for compromise, peace can be accomplished. Both sides need to remain open-minded and be ready to compromise. Israeli occupation of the West Bank is not permanent. It is necessary until such time as a stable, peaceful government can be set up in the West Bank. Accomplishing this will be a long and difficult process that will require the healing of deep wounds. It is, however, the only possible solution.

Notes:

[1]Abba Eban, *Heritage:Civilization and the Jews*, Summit Books, 1984, pp. 31-91.
[2]ibid., p.94.
[3]ibid., p.106.
[4]Almog, Shmuel, *Nationalism and Antisemitism in Modern Europe*, Permagon Press, 1990, p.xii.
[5]Smith, Charles, *Palestine and the Arab-Israeli Conflict*, St. Martin's Press, 1989, p.27.
[6]Smith, p.112.
[7]Hilberg, Raul, *The Destruction of the European Jews*, Quadrangle Books, 1961, p.715.
[8]Herzog, Chaim, *Who Stands Accused?*, Random House, 1978, p.19.
[9]Davis, Leonard, *Myths and Facts 1989*, Near East Report, 1989, p.21.
[10]Davis, p.140.
[11]Herzog, p.42.
[12]ibid., p.43.
[13]Davis, p.112.
[14]Herzog, p.68.
[15]Davis, p.42.
[16]Averick, Sara and Rosen, Steven, *The Importance of the 'West Bank' and Gaza to Israel's Security*, AIPAC Papers on US-Israel Relations, 1985, p.17
[17]Herzog, p.72.
[18]ibid., p.74.
[19]Herzog, p.55.
[20]Davis, p.46.
[21]Aumann, Moshe, "The Palestinian Labyrinth", Israel Academic Committee on the Middle East, 1985, p.26.
[22]Libyan News Agency, 1 May, 1990, also quoted by Agence France Presse.
[23]Associated Press, 7 June 1990.
[24]Herzog, p.57.
[25]Davis, p.66.

The YPM Debate

The YPM Debate is a forum designed to provide alternate views on controversial topics. Each debate consists of a series of articles published in the same issue or in two or more consecutive issues. Each article is independent–subsequent articles are not responses to previous ones as they are all written simultaneously and each author does not know the identity of the others. If you would like to take part in a YPM Debate, please contact the Editor at 436-1000 as soon as possible, as debates take some time to arrange.

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Enemies on the Right

Jeff Campione

6 November 1988 was the fateful day. As if the Republicans did not have enough of a burden already, after four months of smear tactics, George Bush would ascend to the White House that evening, only to confront what was still a rather negative public opinion, a huge federal deficit, and a securely Democratic Congress. What happened in Louisiana that night did nothing but further compound the GOP's troubles. Despite firm protests and opposition from both Bush's camp and Republican National Committee Chairman Lee Atwater, David Duke, former Grand Wizard of the Ku Klux Klan, began his political career with a victory in his bid for a seat in the Louisiana State House of Representatives. Duke's margin of victory in an all-white suburb of New Orleans was scant (he held an advantage of 277 out of 16,688 votes), but it was enough to prompt the Party to retaliate. "Atwater denounced Duke and effectively read him out of the national party. But maybe too late. Duke is now a Louisiana Representative with ambitions for higher office, a prospect that could further damage Atwater's already severly crippled hopes of wooing black voters back to the party of Lincoln."[1]

It is almost as if the Republican ideology has been spread too thin

As Atwater's reaction emphasizes, the issue at stake is far greater than a single seat in Louisiana's Congress. Indeed, Duke's election epitomizes the deadlock Atwater and the GOP leadership continually face: nothing short of factions within the Party. It is almost as if the Republican ideology has been spread too thin: Atwater and Bush are desparately trying to hang onto the "Reagan Democrats," the middle and lower classes whose discontent propelled the conservative agenda to the forefront ten, six, and to some extent even two years ago.

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Dissatisfied with, if not plagued by, failing Keynesian solutions to stagflation and the continual embarrassment of the United States in its foreign operations, in 1980 "the masses" turned to Ronald Reagan and his promises of lower taxes, greater prosperity, and a strengthened US military position. Since Americans were satisfied with his initial attempts to achieve these goals, Reagan won a landslide victory in 1984, documenting the changed perception of the GOP into the party of the people.

This transformation was achieved through a restructuring of the Republican agenda, a marriage between economic growth and right-wing conservatism: supply-side economics. As early as 1974, Arthur Laffer began to preach that a decrease in the marginal tax rate would stimulate enough growth to constitute an actual *increase* in government revenues. This would stimulate investment which would in turn enhance productivity, i.e., greater output for less price on an aggregate level.[2] In other words, supply-siders argued that by cutting taxes, a personal political enhancement for the President, the Reagan administration could cut inflation, unemployment, and the federal deficit in one blow while still providing funds for an improved military. This "New Right" permitted laissez-faire conservatives like Laffer, George Gilder and Jack Kemp to unite with military hawks like Alexander Haig. More important, the union permitted "neo-conservatism" as an institution to appear to be a sympathetic solution to the economic misfortunes of all classes.

For the most part, the New Right's theories were correct. When the first capital gains decrease was enacted in 1979, opponents claimed that the drop from 49% to 28%t would cost the government $1.7 billion. In fact, the Treasury collected a $1.1 billion increase in revenues directly from capital gains.[3] The Kemp-

Roth legislation at the beginning of the decade decreased the marginal income tax rate by ten percent in both 1982 and 1983, and, once the Federal Reserve was satisfied with the decrease in inflation in late 1982, it dropped interest rates, setting up complementary fiscal and monetary policies which propelled the US into one of its greatest growth booms ever.

As early as 1986, however, Reaganomics was on the defensive. The Democrats took back the Senate in that year, a success which was primarily the result of one Reagan error: the failure even to maintain, much less cut, the federal deficit.[4] The problem was not so much that social benefits had decreased, for Reagan had always called for limited national government and the assumption of civil responsibility by the state governments. What angered voters was that although the purpose for the decrease in social spending was supposedly to eliminate the deficit while improving those areas inherently national in nature (i.e., the military), what actually resulted was that the decreases in social services continued, yet the deficit kept climbing. Americans felt that they had been taken for a ride, and as a consequence, the first signs of a return of the centrists to the Left ensued.

With the advent Iran-Contra affair and the spread of rumors of the President's senility, the Republicans' straits became even more dire. The nation's Center was shifting away from the Right. This does not necessarily demand a "counter-revolution" to 1980, *per se*, as will be discussed below, but it does force the Republican National Committee to focus all of its efforts on the centrists, hoping that its far right-wing will compromise.

This is precisely the justification behind the great fear that David Duke's victory prompted. The Republican Party must maintain the support of the middle and to do this, it must move ever-so-slightly to the Left. But Duke and other arch-conservatives like Evan Mecham (the impeached Governor of Arizona whose staunch 25% bloc of voting support has made or broken the majority of state office elections in 1986 and 1988 and promises to do the same this month) have mobilized the Far Right for their own good. Were the Party united in this leftward shift, it would be possible to maintain, if not strengthen, Congressional influence on all governmental levels. Instead, the Republicans are factioned, and for at least the near future, this will be evident at the polls.

Factioning, or at least weakening, the Republican Party will shift the current balance between the parties abruptly. Three possibilities seem to cover the continuum, both extremes posing unacceptable dangers to the Republicans. On one end is the most unlikely, the establishment of a multi-party system. It is conceivable that if the Center adopted the doctrine of individual rights as its major stance, a Libertarian Party might be able to lure centrists from both parties and establish itself as an important player. The flipside of that argument is that extremists within the New Right may manipulate agressive policy and posture in response to any movement leftward and become a force of their own.

Elimination of our current system is, however, almost impossible. National and state laws structurally impede any minority party from challenging the existing order. Money is the prime impediment, for in order to receive federal campaign funds, a candidate must produce matching funds from a combination of twenty states. And since the donation cannot be made to individuals, candidates are required to create parties, or at least organizations, creating even greater expense.[5] It is unlikely, therefore, that a modern-day Anti-Mason, Free Soil or Progressive Party could gain a major foothold today.

Secondly, a third party must establish a competitive ideology. But because it is impossible to develop an ideology inherently independent of those of the dominant parties this possibility is not realistic. Each Party leadership needs the middle to gain any ground on the other; and both Parties have empirically mitigated their own philosophies to include the centrists, attempting to create momentum there, and then drag the extremists behind. Hence, should personal liberty become the focus, the Republicans will exploit it as they did the economic plight of the middle class in 1980. As for the extremists, although they may remain a faction within the Party, the inability of either the faction or the main body to act independently will eventually wear both down enough to avoid permanent division.

Weakening of the Republican Party will shift the balance between the parties abruptly

The opposite, yet equally unnerving (for Republicans), end of the continuum is a resurgence of the Left. This seems entirely logical in view of the means behind the Republicans' rise to power in the last decade. The reality is, however, that ten years ago a great number of forces came into play, many of which the

Democrats currently lack.

First of all, the Republicans were bolstered by *tangible* proofs of Democratic inefficiency: the stagflation of the 1970s, the Iran hostage crisis, the then fresh Soviet assertion of military dominance. The people were weary, realized their plight, and turned against the entire institution. Reagan ran against a disliked *status quo*. In 1990, however, the Democratic Party cannot create such a bandwagon. For the most part, the country is not in the economic straits of the 1970s. Granted, it would be foolish and naive to consider either that there has been total realization of all the claims of Reaganomics or that Republicans are solely responsible for the prosperity that has arisen in the last ten years. The federal deficit continues year after year, driving the foreign debt to incredible heights, and this has largely been caused by extensive defense spending, as well as a decrease in personal savings and investment, a result of lower taxes on income and higher taxes on capital gains–all induced by the Reagan administration either through initiation or compromise. The fact remains, nonetheless, that these are *indirect* economic misfortunes which do not necessarily erode support for the *status quo*.

Current dissatisfaction is not with the theories being implemented, but with the implementors themselves

Moreover, to the extent that these pains may influence voters, the Democrats must shoulder some of the blame, nor have they been able to propose a feasible alternative. In 1980, the Democrats held the White House and both chambers of Congress. Two years from now, even with a dynamic Mario Cuomo or Jesse Jackson at the helm, the Democrats will not really have a counter-policy to 1980's trends. Both sides have admitted the need for new incentives to invest, both sides want to eliminate the deficit, neither side wishes to take the blame for raising taxes. In the 1990 and 1992 elections, the choices will be far narrower than they appear.

The most likely result of this situation is a weakening of the Conservative wing in this decade: a general shift back to basics, back to the Center. This is obvious in view of the difficulty both parties face in establishing a new ideology. Current dissatisfaction is not with the theories being implemented, but with the implementors themselves, and is aimed at forcing the politicians on both sides to be more responsive to the electorate. The Republicans are in dire straits politically if they deny the need to eliminate the deficit, modify military expenditures, or address environmental concerns, just as the Democrats must acknowledge the need to induce investment, decrease restrictions on economic competitiveness abroad, and maintain a military conducive to what President Bush has termed "a new world order." A new age of compromise has dawned.

The issues, therefore, are now the focus, and despite divisions within the Party, the Republicans must look to long-term solvency and make themselves receptive to the Center's causes. They may have to lose many fights on the local level, as has already begun in parts of Louisiana and Arizona in order to maintain cohesion on the national level, where extremist politics have never been dominant. If in its federal agenda, furthermore, the Party can appease the Far Right and the Middle again, it may indeed come from behind to win this game.

Bush's compromise over the 1991 fiscal budget is precisely such a gamble. In the midst of a huge military operation in the Middle East, skyrocketing inflation at home, a Savings and Loan crisis, Bush has cast himself in the role of mediating sacrificer by conceding to increased excise, income, and sales taxes, and maintained capital gains taxes, for the sake of reducing the deficit.

By compromising thus, Bush is attempting to mitigate the impact of this potentially disasterous situation and hoping to bear some of the pain now, two years before the election. In this way, Bush could appear in November 1992 to be the President who responded to tough times with tough, risky measures. Even a poor, but hopeful situation, when the outlook was supposed to be very bad, is a boon to an incumbent. If, on the other hand, 1992 rolls around and the US is in economic shambles, Bush will be able to avoid the blame, since his capital gains stimulant was axed. Either way, he could quite possibly win, and in the process he would reignite 1980's conservative agenda mandate, reuniting the forces that originally mounted the GOP offensive. As for now, the Party's future depends upon it.

[1] "The GOP's Cross to Bear." *U.S. News and World Report*. 6 March 1989.
[2] "Laffer's Curveball Picks Up Speed." *Fortune*. 23 February 1981.
[3] Buckley, William F., *Right Reason*
[4] Kayden, Xandra and Mahe, Eddie Jr., *The Party Goes On: The persistence of the two-party system in the United States*.
[5] Kayden and Mahe, page 144.

The Persistence of Amnesia: Dachau, 1990

15

Neil Brenner

I didn't hear much German spoken last July when I visited Dachau, a small West German village located just outside of Munich, where less than sixty years ago the first Nazi concentration camp was constructed. The morning of my trip to Dachau I woke up to newspaper headlines which were more concerned with the immediate future of Germany than its not-so-immediate past: "It's the weekend of the Germans," proclaimed one widely-read national paper, "...the first and most important step towards national unity will occur!" On 1 July the West German Deutschmark became the official currency of the DDR, which is now to be integrated into, or perhaps annexed by, the economic, legal, and social system of its capitalist neighbor. As the West celebrates the apparent collapse of Communist hegemony in Eastern Europe, fewer and fewer Germans on both sides of the rapidly-disappearing Berlin Wall seem to think much these days about the Nazi death camps. But in spite of the jubilant mood sweeping through Munich, I was in no mood to celebrate the dubious virtues of strong and unified nations as I stumbled through the iron gate at Dachau and glared at the barbed wire fences and a sign which reads: "*Arbeit macht frei*" – "Work brings freedom."

Surrounded by tourists whose cameras never stopped flashing, I wandered across a field of stones where rows of overcrowded barracks once stood, through a shady garden planted where the firing range used to be, into a museum erected in a building which had housed Nazi officers. I was given a pamphlet which informed me that at least 32,000 prisoners were executed at Dachau between 1933 and 1945. Thousands more died of hunger or disease, while others became the living subjects of crude Nazi experiments. I found myself in the gas chamber, where a sign written in three languages advised with tragic absurdity: "Do not write on the walls."

Had I grown up in Germany in the 1930s, I could have arrived in this room as a young Jew about to be killed; instead I came as an anonymous student from America, trying to understand what happened in Germany fifty or sixty years ago, what has happened since then, and above all, what is happening today. I spent about two months in Germany last summer studying the language, talking to all sorts of people, exploring the cities, museums, and countryside, thinking about the many faces of this nation which is today on the move again–although no one, not even the Germans themselves, seems to know where it is headed.

If I did not feel entirely at ease in this country, it was not because I encountered any visible signs of anti-Semitism–there are hardly enough Jews left in Germany to provoke much of a disturbance–but because I was bewildered and frustrated by the reluctance of so many Germans, young and old, to confront and discuss their own history. I had extended conversations with individual Germans about the Nazis, nationalism, Jews, and concentration camps, but I sensed in society at large a collective refusal openly to explore such issues. To the extent that the younger generations had no direct personal involvement in the Third Reich, this attitude might seem perfectly understandable. Although Fascism is no longer the taboo subject it was during the first decades following the war, the fact is that many young Germans are simply not interested in worrying much about what their parents or grandparents did during the

I was bewildered by the reluctance of so many Germans to confront their own history

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Nazi years. For me this indifference is problematic and potentially dangerous. Many of the same people who refuse to think about Germany's Nazi past are today rather carelessly rejoicing over its imminent reunification.

On the day of my visit to the concentration camp at Dachau, many West Germans appeared to be celebrating either their new economic ties to the DDR, the victory of their soccer team (coached by "Kaiser" Franz) in the world championships, or some disturbingly nationalistic combination of the two. That evening in Munich I watched swarms of ecstatic young people waving huge German flags, honking car horns, chanting slogans: "We are the champions!" In various cities, reported the Berlin *Tageszeitung*, groups of foreigners–Turks, Africans, Vietnamese–were verbally and physically abused. Many took shelter in restaurants, but one Turkish man, nineteen years old, barely escaped the lynching attempt of a frenzied crowd which had engulfed his stalled car. Shops in Kreuzberg, the section of West Berlin with the highest immigrant population, were vandalized. The members of the victorious soccer team were hailed in Frankfurt as the "Heroes of the Nation."

The refusal to confront Naziism is an active attempt to enforce a specific interpretation of the past

It was impossible for me to take lightly the peculiarly nationalistic and political character of soccer hooliganism in Germany in the context of the gas chambers I had seen that day. While I do not believe that the reunification of Germany is going to lead to new concentration camps, I think it would be naive to shrug off these violent incidents as insignificant or irrelevant to the political future of Europe. There may be a basic psychological connection between this indifference toward history and the tendency toward intolerance. The nationalistic jubilation of so many Germans in recent weeks is for me evidence that this nation would like to dive forward into the future without thinking about the past.

Every day I observed the signs of a persistent amnesia, the collective forgetfulness of a culture deeply uncertain about its own identity, yet apparently unwilling to recognize itself in any historical events which occurred prior to the summer of 1945. In my opinion this refusal to confront Naziism is hardly an escape from the horrors of history, but an active and subversive attempt to enforce a specific interpretation of the fascist past–namely, that the Third Reich was a system of mass deception orchestrated by an evil vanguard of leaders, that the populace knew almost nothing of the death camps, and that resistance to the Nazis was never a realistic possibility for most people. The result of this highly problematic and historically inaccurate portrait of fascism in Germany is to allot guilt and responsibility for the Holocaust to a few notorious criminals, like Hitler and Goebbels, and perhaps even worse, to imply that the Holocaust was, in some sense, inevitable.

This false version of Naziism arises through the moral default of the older generations in Germany, out of the arrogant silence of those who, so it seems, would prefer to forget their complicity in the deaths of millions of people. But I think that all human beings are responsible, all of us who can today bear to sit still, or laugh, or write poems, or love, or simply keep on living, in a world where holocausts happen. We are obliged as human beings–German, American, Jewish, Christian, whatever–to preserve the memory of evil in order to prevent its repetition. Consciousness of the immense power with which ideologies of intolerance can tempt people to participate in oppression would be a humanitarian ingredient in any truly democratic political program. This does not mean that we should become reconciled to the Holocaust, but the exact opposite–a constant confrontation with the monstrous contradiction, that we can neither change what has already happened nor accept it with a clear conscience. Awareness of this contradiction might enable us to translate our outrage into sensitivity to the suffering which surrounds us, to transform our disgust into tolerance.

The Germans may have good reasons this year to look forward to a brighter and happier future, but a few voices in Germany still wonder about the present euphoria in the context of the past. In a recent issue of *Der Spiegel*, a popular West German magazine, the following letter appeared, constructing a grim chronology for the reunified German nation: "July 1: monetary, economic, social union; August 1: annexation of the parts of the DDR; December 2: all-German elections–and next September we'll be attacking Poland again!" I don't know if the reunification of Germany will in fact turn out to be a threat to Poland's borders, but I do hope that, as the Germans build a new society together, they keep in mind the words carved into one of the monuments to the dead I saw at Dachau: "*Es darf nie wieder geschehen!*"–"May it never happen again"

India's Dilemma

Gautam Dutta 17

When Saddam Hussein invaded Kuwait, President Bush was presented with two options: to counter the invasion militarily, or to marshal support for Iraq's ostracism from the international community. To date, Bush has preferred the latter course–and achieved phenomenal results. In a diplomatic triumph for the President, the United Nations Security Council approved consecutive resolutions condemning the Iraqi invasion as a flagrant violation of international law. Long reviled in the UN, America has finally rejoined the body as an eager participant.

Unfortunately, one week's encore will hardly suffice to oust Hussein from Kuwait (and ideally from Iraq as well). Bush faces a crucial juncture, for he must maintain his diverse and unwieldy international coalition amidst other geopolitical distractions. In this capacity, one can draw vivid insight from the current dilemma of India, which has failed to condemn the invasion.

Due to its heavy economic dependence on both Kuwait and Iraq, India cannot view the Iraqi invasion as a matter of good against evil–with Hussein portrayed as evil incarnate. In order to arrive at a more comprehensive judgment regarding India's commitment to Kuwaiti sovereignty, one must first consider the international scene from that nation's perspective.

India's first Prime Minister, Jawarhalal Nehru, first coined the term "Third World" to describe the ongoing transformation of colonies into nations. Like many other countries, India was confronted with extreme poverty and inequity of resources and opportunity. As a remedy, Nehru adopted a socialist blueprint for the nation–a blueprint anathema to the capitalist ideal of foreign investment.

Meanwhile, Indo-American relations lost their cordiality during the Nixon Presidency–principally due to America's support of Pakistan. In fact, American underwriting of undemocratic Pakistani regimes dates back to the beginning of the Cold War. Anxious to impede further Soviet advances in Asia, Washington willingly bankrolled Pakistani dictators in exchange for a sizable American military presence in the region. This patron-client relationship was intensified following the Soviet invasion of Afghanistan in 1979: Pakistan emerged as the conduit for the American arms flow to the *mujehadin* rebels.

For over four decades, American and Indian foreign policies diverged. By necessity, the United States supported Pakistan, India's historic nemesis. The 1947 partition of India and Pakistan–the brainchild of Lord Mountbatten–resulted in a highly volatile conflict between both nations. Since then, they have fought three wars for control of Kashmir, an area which remains in dispute.

India cannot view the Iraqi invasion as a matter of good against evil–with Hussein as evil incarnate

India still rankles from past American disapproval of its conduct on the Indian subcontinent. Even now, the United States does not recognize Indian annexation of the territories of Sikkim and Portuguese Goa. The 1971 Bangladeshi rebellion against Pakistan, however, caused the most damage to Indo-American relations. Burdened by an onslaught of refugees from East Pakistan, Prime Minister Indira Gandhi lent her support to the separation of Bangladesh from East Pakistan–which infuriated President Nixon. To express his great concern over India's actions, Nixon unsubtly

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sent several warships to the Bay of Bengal. In the process, he probably set back the cause of bilateral relations by two decades.

Furthermore, the East India Company instilled a lingering element of visceral economic xenophobia in the national psyche, for the British first established their colonial dominance in India principally by mercantile, not military means. As a result, foreign investment in India is quite restricted–and Americans do not appreciate restrictions on their trade. All corporations must be controlled by a majority of nationals; all national banks are government-owned.

This Indian hostility towards multinational firms manifested itself in 1979 when India ejected Coca-Cola from the Indian market. Essentially, the government sought the beverage's secret formula—a request that the company naturally refused. Barely a decade later, rival Pepsico was allowed to enter. (Its soft drink, however, had to be renamed "Lehar 'Wave' Pepsi" so that its contrived "Indian" character would be manifest.)

This clash between Indian and American economic values was embodied by the 1988 Omnibus Trade Act, which addressed protectionism in foreign markets. The act cited the Indian nationalization of the insurance industry and lack of patent protection as prohibitive to free trade. If India failed to comply with this so-called Super-301 Provision, India would be denied most-favored nation status–and its exports subject to additional tariffs. Us Trade Representative Carla A. Hills temporarily waived the penalty provision last year, however, in the faint hope that India may change its policy.

India, although constitutionally a secular republic, must constantly address the centrifugal forces of religious and ethnic strife. India's diverse society features twenty-six languages and over two hundred dialects. Besides the tragedy of poverty, India must confront an increasingly aggressive Hindu majority, a defensive Muslim minority, a Sikh insurgency, and tribal rebellions. Amid such volatile tensions, however, democracy nevertheless has been firmly established since 1947, a most remarkable achievement.

Immediately prior to Hussein's act of aggression, three domestic crises simmered in New Delhi: rebellion in Kashmir, Hindu-Muslim strife in the holy city of Ayodha, and outrage over a radical affirmative-action program. Over the issue of Kashmir, India and Pakistan reached the brink of war, as troops of both sides mobilized along the *de facto* border lines. India charged that Pakistan was aiding the Kashmiri insurgency against the Central (federal) Government–which accusation Pakistan angrily denied. Violence in the scenic resort region was so rampant that Indian troops at one point had to enforce continual curfews to maintain order.

As a result, the local population was embittered toward the government, for their two most vital industries–tourism and apples–were destroyed: Kashmir's economy now lies in shambles. Quite ingeniously, the rebels usually attacked Indian troops from crowds. In the retaliatory fire many innocent bystanders were killed–further alienating the residents of the only Muslim-dominated state in India.

A religious storm brewed meanwhile in the holy city of Ayodha–where violence erupted over a disputed shrine of both Hinduism and Islam. Until the sixteenth century, Hindu devotees flocked to the city as a holy site of the god Rama. After the Mughal ruler Babur erected a mosque on top of the temple, followers of both religions coexisted in harmony–until last year.

The elections that toppled Rajiv Gandhi from power marked the resurgence of Hindu fundamentalism. In order to form his minority-based government, Prime Minister V.P. Singh had to ally his Janata party with the militant Hindu BJP, the Bharatiya Janata Party, on the right and the Communist Party on the left. Currently, the BJP is leading a campaign to oust the Babur mosque from the temple–a direct challenge to the avowed secular policy of V.P. Singh.

The Singh government, however, faces a political firestorm over its controversial affirmative-action plan, where the government would reserve an astonishing 49.5 percent for lower-castes and Muslims; only the remaining jobs would be awarded on the basis of merit. Upper-class, educated Hindus, who stand to lose the most, reacted in outrage and organized mass protests. Despite many suicides in the protest, the Singh government has yet to budge.

Thus, India's approach toward the boycott of Iraq has been necessarily ambiguous on purely political grounds. The government simply cannot afford to alienate the Muslims, who constitute one fifth of the population. As a staunch supporter of the PLO, Hussein has thus

far succeeded in wrapping his predatory attacks under the sacrosanct aegis of pan-Arabism.

Furthermore, India has been drawn into an intricate economic arrangement with both Iraq and Kuwait. Prior to Kuwait's storming, over 40,000 Indians worked in the emirate–adding millions to India's scant foreign exchange reserves. Meanwhile, India had always conducted a barter arrangement with Iraq, whereby Indian food staples were exchanged for Iraqi oil. Besides, there were 130,000 Indians working in Iraq. Dependent on Iraq for both half its oil and for its people's welfare, India faced a diplomatic quandary.

Given the current circumstances, India could (in diplomatese) release an official statement "regretting" the use of Iraqi force–and call for an equitable solution for all parties concerned. In this manner, it would be able to evacuate its remaining people from Iraq and Kuwait safely. India might thus be instrumental in providing Hussein with a device to save face as he withdraws.

It is clear, however, that India will suffer financially from the long Mideast standoff, regardless of who will be the ultimate victor. The suffering, paradoxically, may provide an opening to further economic liberalization in India, however. Western (particularly American) companies could, in a sense, reimburse India for its losses–with greater investment. Moreover, how could one resist the opportunity to enter a market as huge as India's? Gradually, Indians would come to appreciate *subtle*, nonthreatening foreign investment; only goodwill could follow.

As the world's most populous democracy, India looks back at four decades of achievement, yet several grave challenges lie ahead. The human maladies of poverty, environmental destruction, and social and political injustice need to be addressed not simply on a national, but on a global level. With the recession of the Cold War, India and the United States should finally see their common republican ground–and embark on joint initiatives to alleviate the vicious cycle of want and poverty.

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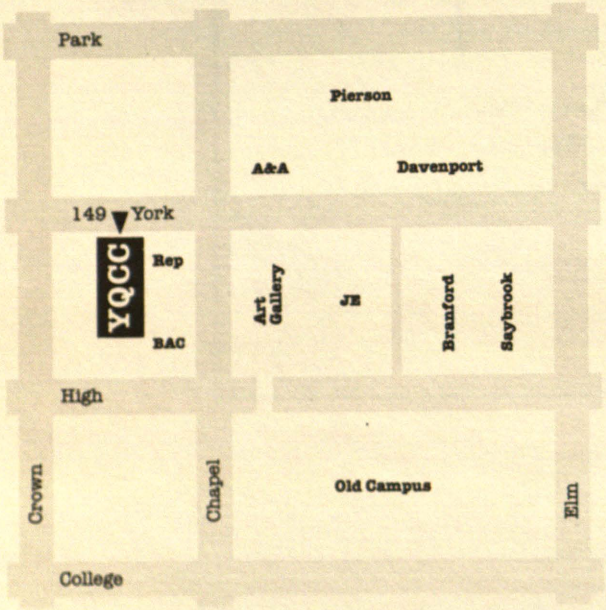

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